



AP[®] United States Government and Politics Practice Exam

From the 2012 Administration

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UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

Section I

Time—45 minutes

60 Questions

Directions: Each of the questions or incomplete statements below is followed by five suggested answers or completions. Select the one that is best in each case and then fill in the corresponding circle on the answer sheet.

1. The Articles of Confederation implemented the principle of
 - (A) a strong national government
 - (B) a unified system of taxes
 - (C) universal suffrage
 - (D) an independent judiciary
 - (E) state sovereignty
2. Which of the following is a way Congress can influence the federal judiciary?
 - (A) It can prohibit judicial activism.
 - (B) It can filibuster decisions made by courts.
 - (C) It can change appellate jurisdiction of federal courts.
 - (D) It can review federal judges for reappointment every ten years.
 - (E) It can exercise oversight authority over rulings of individual justices.
3. The framers of the Constitution intended to establish
 - (A) a representative republic
 - (B) a direct democracy
 - (C) an authoritarian state
 - (D) a socialist democracy
 - (E) a parliamentary republic
4. Which of the following powers is shared by the House of Representatives and the Senate?
 - (A) Holding trials of impeachment
 - (B) Establishing federal courts
 - (C) Approving treaties
 - (D) Holding confirmation hearings
 - (E) Approving major presidential appointments
5. Which of the following best describes a purpose of the Establishment Clause?
 - (A) It gives Congress the power to protect civil rights and civil liberties.
 - (B) It prohibits Congress from establishing a state religion.
 - (C) It empowers Congress to create a national bank.
 - (D) It prevents Congress from prohibiting the possession of guns on school grounds.
 - (E) It grants Congress the power to establish post roads and post offices.

6. Which of the following committees plays a major role in the House in shaping tax policy?
 - (A) Finance
 - (B) Ways and Means
 - (C) Commerce
 - (D) Appropriations
 - (E) Governmental Affairs
7. Which of the following is most frequently reported in the media during a presidential election?
 - (A) Results from public opinion polls that indicate which candidates are most likely to win
 - (B) The official platforms of each of the major political parties
 - (C) Financial strategies and management of the campaigns
 - (D) Comparisons of candidates' positions on foreign and domestic policy issues
 - (E) Information about the candidates' experience in government and record in office
8. The passing of the Voting Rights Act of 1965 is a significant political event because it
 - (A) scaled back the provisions of the Fifteenth Amendment
 - (B) was used to emancipate southern African Americans
 - (C) was declared unconstitutional by the United States Supreme Court in *Shaw v. Reno*
 - (D) was instrumental in increasing the number of African American and other minority voters
 - (E) required that minority officeholders be elected
9. Many scholars argue that categorical grants-in-aid do which of the following?
 - (A) Give states far too much power over national monies
 - (B) Broaden state power beyond that outlined in the Constitution
 - (C) Strengthen the impact of the Tenth Amendment
 - (D) Give new life to the idea of dual federalism
 - (E) Weaken the power of state governors and legislators
10. Party identification in the United States is most successfully transmitted by which of the following?
 - (A) Workplace
 - (B) Church
 - (C) Educational system
 - (D) The media
 - (E) Family
11. Advocates of shifting the task of drawing United States House districts from state legislatures to independent commissions are likely to claim which of the following as an advantage of independent commissions?
 - (A) House districts drawn by independent commissions are immune from challenges by the United States Department of Justice.
 - (B) Independent commissions are more likely to create majority-minority districts where they are appropriate.
 - (C) Independent commissions significantly reduce the influence of partisan gerrymandering in the redistricting process.
 - (D) Independent commissions are more likely to create districts where minor parties can be victorious.
 - (E) Independent commissions are more able to draw legislative districts that comply with the one person, one vote standard.
12. Which of the following is NOT an explanation for low voter turnout?
 - (A) Registration requirements
 - (B) Low political efficacy among many voters
 - (C) Laws protecting minority voting rights
 - (D) Frequent elections at the state and local level
 - (E) Weekday elections

13. Which of the following individuals would be most likely to vote in a Republican primary?
- (A) A 25-year-old white male with some high school education who is employed as a laborer in Florida
 - (B) A 55-year-old African American saleswoman from Georgia who has a master's degree
 - (C) A 65-year-old Hispanic male from California who is retired and lives on social security
 - (D) A 35-year-old female secretary from New York with an associate's degree who is a devout Catholic
 - (E) A 45-year-old white businessman from South Carolina who attends church weekly
14. In the United States political system, the term Federalism refers to
- (A) limits on the powers of the state governments
 - (B) limits on the powers of the national government
 - (C) the division of powers between the levels of government
 - (D) the fundamental basis of law
 - (E) legal authority of the courts to hear cases
15. Rules and regulations created by an agency such as the Federal Communications Commission are called
- (A) constitutional law
 - (B) statutory law
 - (C) common law
 - (D) equity law
 - (E) administrative law
16. The agenda-setting function of the media refers to the power to
- (A) endorse specific candidates for political office
 - (B) favor the position of one interest group over another
 - (C) counter the censorship activities of media watch groups
 - (D) mobilize economic interests in favor of a particular candidate
 - (E) decide which issues are important enough to bring to public attention
17. Which of the following is true of political action committees (PACs) ?
- (A) They make campaign contributions in hopes of gaining access to legislators.
 - (B) They are a part of political party organizations.
 - (C) They are allowed to contribute to only one candidate in any election.
 - (D) They nominate candidates for president at national party conventions.
 - (E) They operate at the state level but not at the national level.
18. Which of the following is a correct statement about the federal government's role in interstate commerce?
- (A) The federal government has no role in regulating interstate commerce.
 - (B) The federal government's role is limited to regulating activities that may lead to federal crimes.
 - (C) The federal government's role is limited to regulating commerce transported on interstate waterways such as the Mississippi River.
 - (D) The federal government's role is limited to regulating the transport of agricultural goods.
 - (E) The federal government's role has been greatly expanded through the interpretation of the interstate commerce clause.
19. Even with large majorities of their own party in Congress, presidents experience difficulty in exercising legislative leadership because
- (A) the president must compete against state governors for influence
 - (B) the weak nature of political parties hampers the president's ability to control Congress
 - (C) the president's use of the veto is ineffective with Congress
 - (D) individual members of Congress attract greater publicity when challenging the president
 - (E) the president seldom addresses the same issues as members of Congress

20. Which of the following constitutional provisions broadened the power of Congress?
- (A) The necessary and proper clause
 - (B) The equal protection clause
 - (C) The Tenth Amendment
 - (D) The Ninth Amendment
 - (E) The eminent domain provision in the Fifth Amendment
21. The most widely performed act of political participation in the United States is
- (A) writing letters to public officials
 - (B) voting in local elections
 - (C) voting in presidential elections
 - (D) contributing money to political candidates
 - (E) attending local party meetings
22. According to James Madison, which of the following best controls the effects of faction?
- (A) Direct democracy
 - (B) The popular election of state judges
 - (C) A large republic
 - (D) Property requirements for eligibility to work
 - (E) The creation of a merit-based civil service
23. Generally, when is a president more likely to get congressional approval of proposed policies?
- (A) After midterm congressional elections
 - (B) In the second term rather than in the first
 - (C) When public opinion is sharply divided over policies
 - (D) In social policy areas rather than in economic policy areas
 - (E) In foreign affairs rather than in domestic affairs
24. Legislation forbidding flag burning was deemed unconstitutional because it violated the
- (A) First Amendment's free exercise clause
 - (B) necessary and proper clause
 - (C) First Amendment's protection of expression
 - (D) Fourteenth Amendment's definition of citizenship
 - (E) First Amendment's establishment clause
25. Voter turnout tends to be highest among
- (A) college-educated voters
 - (B) working-class voters
 - (C) African American voters
 - (D) young voters
 - (E) low-income voters
26. Which of the following actions by a congressional representative is an example of "pork barreling"?
- (A) Misusing campaign contributions
 - (B) Directing federal funds into the representative's district through legislation
 - (C) Accepting money from a political action committee (PAC)
 - (D) Attempting to kill a bill with unacceptable amendments
 - (E) Voting for a salary increase
27. In response to the Bipartisan Campaign Reform Act (McCain-Feingold Act), the United States Supreme Court, in *Citizens United v. Federal Election Commission* (2010), ruled that
- (A) limits cannot be placed upon candidates' contributions to their own campaigns
 - (B) independent campaign expenditures by corporations and unions are protected by the First Amendment
 - (C) limits on issue advertisements 90 days before an election are unconstitutional
 - (D) limits on campaign contributions by minors are constitutional under the First Amendment
 - (E) requiring endorsement statements in campaign advertisements is unconstitutional

28. The primary responsibility for determining monetary policy in the United States rests with the
- (A) International Monetary Fund
 - (B) World Bank
 - (C) Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System
 - (D) Treasury Department
 - (E) Comptroller of the Currency
29. All of the following make it difficult for presidents to control the actions of federal agencies EXCEPT
- (A) the civil service system
 - (B) issue networks (iron triangles)
 - (C) bureaucratic inertia
 - (D) bureaucratic noncompliance
 - (E) the appointment of cabinet heads
30. Which of the following is an example of checks and balances in action in the United States government?
- (A) The House and Senate cannot agree on the same version of a bill to send to the president.
 - (B) The president issues an executive order that freezes federal government hiring.
 - (C) The president vetoes a bill passed by Congress.
 - (D) The voters reject the status quo and elect all new members of Congress.
 - (E) The voters at the state level elect a governor from a party other than the president's.
31. In *Roe v. Wade*, the majority of Supreme Court justices determined that
- (A) a constitutional right to privacy necessitated making contraceptives legal
 - (B) abortions could be performed only during the first twelve weeks of a pregnancy
 - (C) homosexuality is unconstitutional
 - (D) the United States Constitution implies a right to privacy and thus made abortions legal
 - (E) a husband is allowed to veto his wife's decision to have an abortion
32. Congressional oversight refers to the power of Congress to
- (A) override presidential vetoes
 - (B) hold public hearings before confirming judicial appointees
 - (C) exercise some control over executive agencies
 - (D) allow nongovernmental agencies to defend or refute pending legislation publicly
 - (E) seek judicial opinion on the constitutionality of pending legislation
33. With respect to prayer in public schools, the United States Supreme Court has ruled that
- (A) state-sponsored prayer violates the establishment clause of the First Amendment
 - (B) state-sponsored prayer is permitted by the free exercise clause of the First Amendment
 - (C) since educational policy is controlled largely by state governments, the First Amendment does not affect school policy on prayer
 - (D) the free exercise clause permits teachers to mandate silent prayer
 - (E) in school districts in which local authorities can demonstrate that all students belong to a single religion, mandated prayer is permissible
34. Executive agreements have been cited as evidence that
- (A) modern presidents often try to avoid legislative checks and balances on their authority
 - (B) the executive branch has become too large and bureaucratic
 - (C) presidents have less power in handling foreign policy than in handling domestic policy
 - (D) interest groups have too much power in the contemporary governmental system
 - (E) the courts have few means of limiting presidential power

35. The grandfather clause is significant in United States political history for which of the following reasons?
- (A) It was a means whereby elderly voters were excluded from the electorate.
 - (B) It was declared unconstitutional by the Fifteenth Amendment.
 - (C) It was a means whereby Black citizens in southern states were disenfranchised.
 - (D) It was created by the Supreme Court's decision in *Plessy v. Ferguson*.
 - (E) It was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka*.
36. Most of the work of legislating in Congress takes place in
- (A) joint committees
 - (B) ad hoc committees
 - (C) select committees
 - (D) conference committees
 - (E) standing committees
37. Which of the following is a primary function of the Senate Judiciary Committee?
- (A) Conducting oversight hearings on the Supreme Court budget
 - (B) Conducting investigations into allegedly subversive activities
 - (C) Conducting hearings on judicial appointments made by the president
 - (D) Conducting investigations into wrongdoing by the executive branch
 - (E) Initiating appointments to the Supreme Court
38. Which of the following describes the social contract theory as advanced by John Locke?
- (A) It is an agreement between political actors to maintain their grip on power.
 - (B) It is an agreement in which the government promises to provide a minimum standard of living to citizens.
 - (C) It is an agreement in which the government promises to protect the natural rights of people.
 - (D) It is an agreement between economic elites to maintain a stable economy.
 - (E) It is an agreement in which the government outlines socially acceptable norms of political behavior.
39. In the United States judicial system, when a judge decides a case based on decisions rendered in similar cases in the past, the judge is following the principle of
- (A) amicus curiae
 - (B) stare decisis
 - (C) justiciability
 - (D) diversity
 - (E) certiorari
40. After a constitutional amendment has been proposed by both houses of Congress, its adoption requires
- (A) official filing with the secretary of state
 - (B) support by a majority vote of the people
 - (C) signature by the president
 - (D) ratification by three-fourths of the states
 - (E) publication in the *Federal Register*

41. One of the best strategies that interest groups can use to achieve their goals is
- (A) pressing for changes in high-profile public policies
 - (B) lobbying members of Congress to make small changes in existing policy
 - (C) using the judiciary to invalidate federal legislation
 - (D) encouraging states to use their Tenth Amendment rights and ignore federal law
 - (E) running candidates for office
42. The National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) and the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) are examples of
- (A) cabinet departments
 - (B) independent agencies
 - (C) Executive Office bureaus
 - (D) congressional committees
 - (E) White House staff agencies
43. In which of the following circumstances would the rule of four be applied?
- (A) Four senators agree to a cloture motion.
 - (B) Congress adjourns its session within four days of submitting a bill to the president, and the president does not act.
 - (C) Four states request a writ of certiorari.
 - (D) At least four justices on the Supreme Court agree that a case should be put on the Court's docket.
 - (E) The House Rules Committee limits floor debate to four minutes maximum for each member.
44. Why is federal case law more frequently established by the United States courts of appeal than by the United States Supreme Court?
- (A) Courts of appeal must decide cases appealed to it from the lower courts, while the Supreme Court can choose its cases and hears relatively few each year.
 - (B) Courts of appeal usually have jurisdiction over cases appealed from state supreme courts.
 - (C) There are more judges on the courts of appeal than on the Supreme Court, so they can overrule the Supreme Court's decisions.
 - (D) According to the Constitution, rulings by the courts of appeal have more significance than Supreme Court rulings.
 - (E) Federalism stresses the court decision closest to the people should stand.
45. All of the following are examples of a linkage institution influencing the policy process EXCEPT
- (A) the president delivering the State of the Union speech
 - (B) the Sierra Club lobbying the Environmental Protection Agency
 - (C) the outcome of a congressional election
 - (D) an exposé by the national media on the housing crisis
 - (E) the Republican Party pursuing a balanced budget amendment
46. A discharge petition is rarely used in the House of Representatives because
- (A) it is unconstitutional to use a discharge petition in the House of Representatives
 - (B) the House is too large for a discharge petition to be effective
 - (C) a two-thirds majority is required to issue a discharge petition
 - (D) it is a challenge to majority leadership and informal rules of behavior
 - (E) the unscheduled use of a discharge petition could offend members of the Senate

47. Which of the following is a principle underlying the Bill of Rights?
- (A) The people should control all aspects of governance.
 - (B) Some rights are fundamental and should not be subject to majoritarian control.
 - (C) The legislature should be the most powerful branch of government.
 - (D) All people should be guaranteed the same rights, whether they are citizens or not.
 - (E) It is groups rather than individuals that have fundamental rights and immunities.
48. Since the 1960s, support for the Democratic Party has declined the most among which of the following groups?
- (A) Labor union members
 - (B) Business leaders
 - (C) African Americans
 - (D) Native Americans
 - (E) White southerners
49. The House Rules Committee is an important part of the legislative process because it
- (A) determines ethics rules for members' conduct
 - (B) determines whether a bill should be referred to a policy committee for consideration
 - (C) determines the terms and conditions of debate when a bill goes to the House floor
 - (D) has the authority to limit the Speaker and Minority leader in their use of patronage
 - (E) negotiates compromises on bills with the Senate Rules Committee
50. The president cannot veto which of the following?
- (A) Joint resolutions that propose constitutional amendments
 - (B) Laws overturning United States Supreme Court decisions
 - (C) Legislation regulating congressional salaries
 - (D) Legislation affecting foreign policy
 - (E) Bills that originate in the Senate
51. To influence policy making by the federal courts, the president may do all of the following EXCEPT
- (A) take partisanship into account in making judicial appointments
 - (B) take political ideology into account in making judicial appointments
 - (C) fire and replace federal judges
 - (D) make public statements about issues that might appear before the courts
 - (E) encourage the Justice Department to get involved in cases that test certain issues
52. An example of a discretionary item in the federal budget is
- (A) interest on the public debt
 - (B) spending on national parks
 - (C) Social Security payments
 - (D) veterans' pensions
 - (E) liquidation of prior obligations
53. Which of the following is LEAST characteristic of the history of political parties in the United States during the twentieth century?
- (A) An increase in the number of organized interest groups
 - (B) An increase in the influence of political action committee (PAC) money in congressional elections
 - (C) State adoption of direct primary elections
 - (D) The loss of party patronage power
 - (E) The splitting of the two major parties into a multiparty system

54. The United States Supreme Court decision in *Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka* was based on which of the following?
- (A) The First Amendment's right to freedom of expression
 - (B) The Fourteenth Amendment's due process clause
 - (C) The Fourteenth Amendment's guarantee of equal protection
 - (D) The Fourth Amendment's exclusionary rule
 - (E) The Fifth Amendment's power of eminent domain
55. When a bill passes the House and the Senate in different versions, the bill is resolved by which of the following types of committee?
- (A) Conference
 - (B) Select
 - (C) Reconciliation
 - (D) Rules
 - (E) Standing
56. Candidates for political office use public opinion polls for all of the following purposes EXCEPT to
- (A) assess recognition of the candidate's name
 - (B) measure voters' support for the candidate's issues
 - (C) bring the opposition's opinions into alignment with those of the candidate
 - (D) fine-tune policy stands
 - (E) identify key issues among the voters
57. The clause in the United States Constitution that states that federal law will prevail in the event of a conflict between federal and state law is known as the
- (A) necessary and proper clause
 - (B) supremacy clause
 - (C) presentment clause
 - (D) confrontation clause
 - (E) equal protection clause
58. Which of the following stages comes first in the policy-making process?
- (A) Agenda setting
 - (B) Legitimation
 - (C) Program evaluation
 - (D) Policy formulation
 - (E) Implementation

59. Which of the following situations best illustrates the meaning of divided government in the United States political system?
- (A) The majority of Supreme Court justices are from one party, but the president is from another.
 - (B) The majority of governors are from one party, but the president is from another.
 - (C) The president and a majority of members of Congress are from one party, but the majority of governors are from another.
 - (D) The majority of senators and the majority of representatives are from one party, but the president is from another.
 - (E) The majority of Supreme Court justices are from one party, but the majority of senators and representatives are from another.

60. All of the following are traditional political values held by most Americans EXCEPT
- (A) individual freedom
 - (B) representative democracy
 - (C) equality of opportunity
 - (D) equality of outcome
 - (E) due process of law

END OF SECTION I.

**IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, YOU MAY
CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS SECTION.**

DO NOT GO ON TO SECTION II UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

MAKE SURE YOU HAVE DONE THE FOLLOWING.

- **PLACED YOUR AP NUMBER LABEL ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **WRITTEN AND GRIDDED YOUR AP NUMBER CORRECTLY ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **TAKEN THE AP EXAM LABEL FROM THE FRONT OF THIS BOOKLET AND PLACED IT ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**

UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

SECTION II

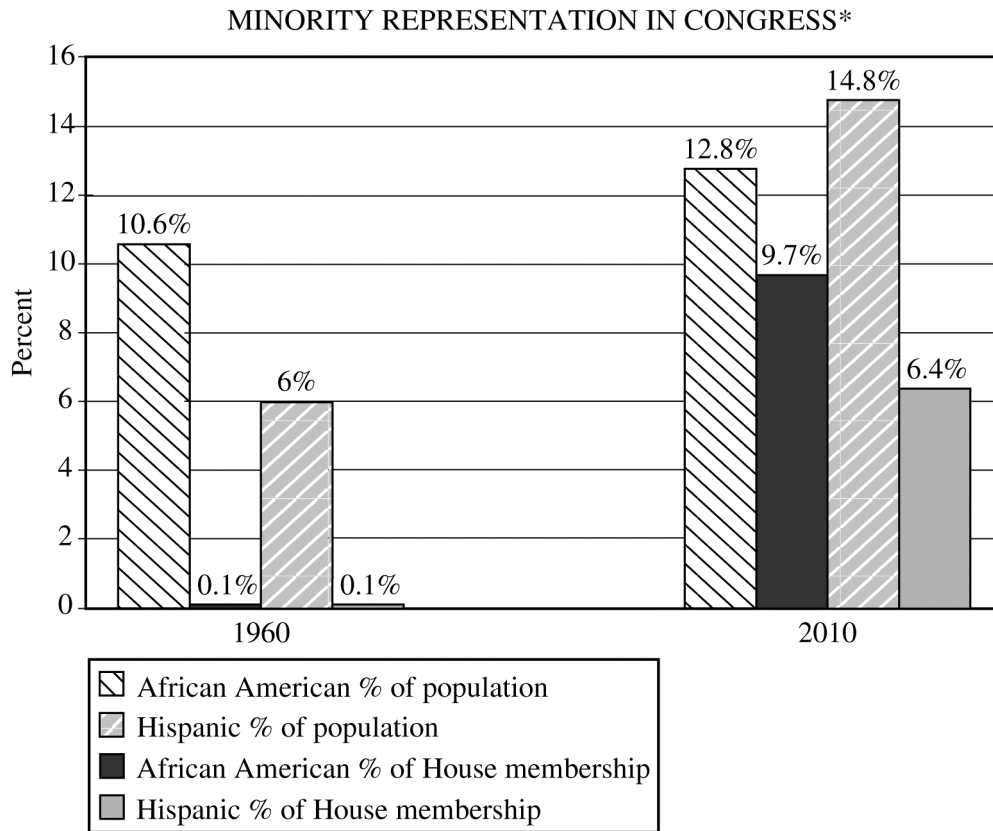
Time—1 hour and 40 minutes

Directions: You have 100 minutes to answer all four of the following questions. Unless the directions indicate otherwise, respond to all parts of all four questions. It is suggested that you take a few minutes to plan and outline each answer. Spend approximately one-fourth of your time (25 minutes) on each question. In your response, use substantive examples where appropriate.

1. Members of Congress are charged with three primary duties—writing laws, overseeing the implementation of laws, and serving the needs of their constituents.
 - (a) Describe the role of each of the following in lawmaking.
 - Senate filibuster
 - House Rules Committee
 - Conference committee
 - (b) Describe one method by which Congress exercises oversight of the federal bureaucracy.
 - (c) Explain how casework affects members' attention to legislation.

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*Figure does not include all minority groups in Congress.

2. (a) Using the chart above, compare minority representation in 1960 and 2010.

(b) Explain how each of the following assisted in the removal of barriers to minority voting.

- Voting Rights Act of 1965
- Twenty-fourth Amendment

(c) Identify one barrier that currently impedes minority representation in Congress. Explain why the barrier you identified inhibits minority representation in Congress.

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4. Interest groups seek to influence political processes in ways that benefit their members. In doing so, however, they may not act in the overall public interest.
 - (a) Describe two techniques interest groups use to influence elections.
 - (b) Explain how interest groups use each of the following to influence government decision making.
 - Issue networks (also known as iron triangles)
 - Amicus curiae briefs
 - (c) Explain how each of the following serves to limit interest group influence.
 - The media
 - Pluralism

[illegible]

Answer Key for AP United States Government and Politics Practice Exam, Section I

Multiple-Choice Questions	
Question #	Key
1	E
2	C
3	A
4	B
5	B
6	B
7	A
8	D
9	E
10	E
11	C
12	C
13	E
14	C
15	E
16	E
17	A
18	E
19	B
20	A
21	C
22	C
23	E
24	C
25	A
26	B
27	B
28	C
29	E

30	C
31	D
32	C
33	A
34	A
35	C
36	E
37	C
38	C
39	B
40	D
41	B
42	B
43	D
44	A
45	A
46*	—
47	B
48	E
49	C
50	A
51	C
52	B
53	E
54	C
55	A
56	C
57	B
58	A
59	D
60	D

*Item 46 was not used in scoring.

AP[®] UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

2012 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 1

5 points

Part (a): 3 points

Describe the **role** of each of the following in lawmaking (3 points total, 1 point per role):

- Senate filibuster allows a senator on the floor to:
 - Prevent/delay action on a particular bill.
 - Prevent/delay other business from being conducted.
- Rules Committee schedules or manages the flow of legislation on the floor to:
 - Make it easier or more difficult for a bill to pass.
 - Make the process more efficient/orderly/manageable.
- Conference Committee reconciles differences in House and Senate versions of a bill.

Must describe the role in lawmaking explicitly.

Part (b): 1 point

Describe one **method** by which Congress exercises oversight of the federal bureaucracy (1 point):

- Budgetary process (power of the purse)
- Committee hearings
- Confirmation or rejection of political appointments to the bureaucracy
- Investigations
- New legislation
- Legislative veto

Must describe the context in which Congress uses the method to oversee the bureaucracy.

Part (c): 1 point

Explain **how** casework affects members' attention to legislation (1 point):

- Diverts time, resources, and staff, thus reducing members' ability to focus on legislation.
- Develops awareness of problems, thus focusing more time and resources on related legislation.

A score of zero (0) is assigned to an answer that is completely off task or is on task but earns no points.

A score of dash (—) is assigned to an answer that is blank.

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2012 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 2

5 points

Part (a): 1 point

One point is earned for demonstrating an increase in minority representation between 1960 and 2010.

Part (b): 2 points

One point is earned for an explanation of **how** the Voting Rights Act of 1965 assisted in the removal of barriers to minority voting:

- Eliminating voter registration requirements (e.g., literacy tests, residency requirements) that prevented minorities from voting led to increased access for minority voters.
- Creating federal oversight of elections helped eliminate discriminatory mechanisms (e.g., voter intimidation, ballot fraud) that were used to prevent minority voters from voting, which led to increased access for minority voters.
- Eliminating the use of English-only ballots that prevented non-English-speaking minorities from voting led to increased access for minority voters.

A second point is earned for an explanation of **how** the Twenty-fourth Amendment assisted in the removal of barriers to minority voting: Eliminating poll taxes that limited voting by lower-income people led to an increase in minority voting because minorities are often overrepresented among poor people.

Part (c): 2 points

One point is earned for identifying one barrier that currently impedes minority representation in Congress. The barrier may affect either minority candidates running for Congress **or** minority voters attempting to vote for minority candidates.

Minority Candidates	Minority Voters
• Incumbency advantage • Gerrymandered districts • Majority-minority districts • Prejudice, racism, sexism • Electoral resources • Electoral qualifications • Single-member districts/winner-take-all	• I.D. requirements • English-only ballots • Felony disenfranchisement • Purging voter rolls • Voter intimidation

A second point is earned for explaining **how** the barrier identified above inhibits minority representation in Congress:

- A minority candidate barrier must explain **how** the barrier identified above limits minority representation.
- A minority voter barrier must explain **how** the barrier limits minority participation and **how** that directly affects minority representation in Congress.

A score of zero (0) is assigned to an answer that is completely off task or is on task but earns no points.

A score of dash (—) is assigned to an answer that is blank.

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Question 3

8 points

Part (a): 2 points

One point is earned for each of two descriptions of political factors that affect presidential appointment decisions.

Acceptable descriptions include:

campaign promises	party
gender	potential for confirmation success
geographic diversity	professional background, experience, education
home-state senator (if lower courts)	race
ideology	religion
interest group input	scandal
issue positions	

Part (b): 4 points

One point is earned for each of two identifications of political factors that affect the confirmation process for presidential nominees. One point is earned for each of two explanations for **how** the political factor complicates the confirmation of judicial appointees.

Acceptable factors include:

advice and consent	the media (televising Judiciary Committee hearings)
campaign promises	party
filibuster	professional background, experience, education
gender	race
geographic diversity	religion
holds	safe/weak nominee
home-state senator (if lower courts)	scandal
ideology	senatorial courtesy
interest group input	
issue positions	

Part (c): 1 point

One point is earned for correctly explaining **how** a legislative power serves as a check on court decisions.

Acceptable legislative powers include:

amendments	impeachment
confirmation	jurisdiction stripping
congressional funding	legislation

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Question 3 (continued)

Part (d): 1 point

One point is earned for correctly explaining **how** an executive power serves as a check on court decisions.

Acceptable executive powers include:

- power of appointment
- executive enforcement

A score of dash (—) is assigned to an answer that is blank.

A score of zero (0) is assigned to an answer that is completely off task or is on task but earns no points.

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Question 4

6 points

Part (a): 2 points

One point is earned for each correct description of a technique used by interest groups to influence elections.

Techniques include:

campaign contributions	GOTV efforts
candidate ratings	independent expenditures
endorsements	issue ads
501(c)4	PACs
527	providing information on issue and candidates
funneling volunteers to campaigns	

Notes: Must describe a technique, not merely identify it. No double dipping on PACs and Super PACs.

Part (b): 2 points

One point is earned for an acceptable explanation that demonstrates **how** interest groups use issue networks (iron triangles). One point is also earned for an acceptable explanation that demonstrates **how** interest groups use amicus briefs:

- Interest groups participate in issue networks by providing money, information, and resources in hopes of obtaining political support from Congress, the bureaucracy, or the White House.
- Interest groups use amicus briefs to inform the Court in hopes of influencing the acceptance of cases, Court reasoning, or decisions.

Part (c): 2 points

One point is earned for a correct explanation of **how** the media acts to limit interest group influence. An additional point is earned for a correct explanation of **how** pluralism acts to limit interest group influence:

- Media can act as a gatekeeper of information or a watchdog of interest group behavior.
- Pluralism limits interest group influence because of the competition among a vast number of groups.

A score of zero (0) is assigned to an answer that is completely off-task or is on-task but earns no points.

A score of dash (—) is assigned to an answer that is blank.